

ENERGY



Energy is needed for life, and for every single movement in the whole universe. When you have run a race, you may feel that you have used up all your energy.

But your energy has not been lost, it has changed into different kinds of energy:

movement and heat. When work is done, energy is never lost, but it changes into other kinds of energy. Movement and heat energy are just two of the many different kinds of energy.



Eating energy

We get our energy from food, and we need to eat plants, or animals that have eaten plants, to stay alive. Plants get energy to grow from sunlight, so our energy really comes from the sun.



Sun power

Living things that grew millions of years ago were buried under rock, where they slowly turned into coal, oil, and gas. Energy from these fuels comes from the sun, shining long ago.



Jumping jack

When the lid is closed, the puppet's spring is coiled up, ready to push the puppet out of the box. We say the spring has potential energy. When you open the lid, the spring's potential energy turns into movement energy.

Energy changes

We can't make energy, or destroy it. Instead, energy can change from one kind to another. This toy robot shows how energy may not stay in one form for very long!

